NARCISO SALVADOR

Frontend Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Frontend software engineer with 3.5 years at IBM building production UI for LLM-powered and agentic AI products, most recently watsonx Orchestrate, IBM's AI agent and automation platform. Owns features end-to-end in React and TypeScript, from design handoff to shipped product, including an onboarding redesign that cut new-user drop-off from 40% to 5%. Also brings DevOps and team leadership experience: helped migrate CI/CD for 12 repositories and serves as Iteration Manager.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Software Developer — IBM (San Jose, CA) May 2023 – Present

watsonx Orchestrate — Document Processing (Frontend, primary focus)

- Serve as the frontend developer for the document processing team (4–10 engineers), building the core UI for document classification, extraction, and text extraction.
- Designed and built a dynamic LLM model selector (React, TypeScript, IBM Carbon, TanStack) supporting 20+ models across 3 document-processing components, replacing a hardcoded dropdown with an API-driven combobox that surfaces deprecation, pricing, and legal-notice warnings. Shipped to all watsonx Orchestrate users.
- Redesigned the onboarding flow for a document-processing tool, replacing a crowded first page of competing calls-to-action with one guided action per step. Cut new-user drop-off from 40% to 5% and increased adoption.
- Implemented a state machine for the document lifecycle as the single source of truth for status transitions, blocking impossible state changes and making valid transitions explicit. No state-related bugs reported since launch.
- Helped redesign state management to fix recurring state bugs; tuned TanStack Query caching (staleTime) to cut refetches and re-renders
- Fixed a UI performance bottleneck in the list of user-defined document extraction fields by consolidating up to 3 tooltips per item into 1, cutting tooltip-positioning calculations by up to two-thirds and eliminating the slowdown on lists of 10+ fields.
- Built accessible UI to WCAG 2.2 AA and Section 508, documenting components in Storybook and validating with the IBM Equal Access Accessibility Checker.
- Serve as Release Manager, coordinating and validating container image updates for on-schedule deployments.
- Own features end-to-end: scope requirements with product and design, drive execution across backend, platform, QA, and AI Models teams, and ship 3–5 bug fixes plus a new feature each sprint.

IBM Watson Natural Language Understanding (NLU)

- Helped migrate CI/CD for 12 repositories from Jenkins to IBM Secure Pipeline Service (SPS).
- Serve as Iteration Manager for the NLU team (3.5 years), planning sprint scope and triaging customer-reported issues.

IBM Watson Discovery

- Serve as Security Focal for the Discovery tooling team, remediating 5–10 security vulnerabilities per sprint and fixing platform bugs.

Across teams

- On-call rotation (PagerDuty): resolved 12+ production incidents.
- Mentored an apprentice developer through onboarding and her first features; she converted to a full-time engineer.
- Maintain 80%+ unit test coverage (Vitest), contribute to a Playwright end-to-end suite validated against deployed environments, and review 2–3 pull requests weekly.

Freelance Web Developer — Self-employed (San Francisco, CA) 2022 – 2023

- Designed, built, and launched a website for a law firm client, from requirements through launch.

SKILLS

Frontend: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, HTML, CSS, TailwindCSS, IBM Carbon Design System, Redux, TanStack, React Router, Responsive Design, Web Accessibility

Testing & UI tooling: Vitest, Playwright, Storybook

Backend & data: Node.js, Express, REST APIs, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, MySQL

DevOps, tooling & process: CI/CD (Jenkins, IBM SPS), Git, GitHub, Vite, Nx, Yarn, Grafana, Agile/Scrum, Mentoring

AI: IBM watsonx, Agentic AI Development, Intelligent Document Processing, AI-Assisted Development (Claude)

EDUCATION

100Devs — Full-Stack Web Development Bootcamp (2022 – 2023) | **California Culinary Academy** — Culinary Arts (2005)

PREVIOUS CAREER — CULINARY LEADERSHIP

Culinary Director — Kin Khao (San Francisco, CA) Nov 2018 – Sep 2022

- Led the restaurant to profitability and a one-star Michelin rating, growing profit 200% and managing a team of 50+.

Sous Chef to Executive Chef & BOH Manager — Kin Khao, Glena's, Nobu Hotel Palo Alto Nov 2013 – Oct 2018